Lead Broker Blueprint by Lorenzo Marietti

Module 4 deliverable

Lead-Quality Dispute Decision Tree

A step-by-step framework for handling lead-quality disputes

How to use this tree

When a buyer disputes a delivered lead, work through the decision tree in order. Each branch ends with a specific action and a citation to the contractual section that governs it. The tree assumes you're operating under an LPA structured like the Module 4 sample agreement.

The principle: every disputed lead should resolve cleanly to either "accept return" or "reject dispute," with documented reasoning either way. Vague resolutions are how vendor relationships die.

Step 1 — Was the dispute submitted within the return window?

YES — proceed to Step 2.

NO — REJECT the dispute. Cite the return window in Section 5.2 of the LPA. Do this politely but firmly. If the buyer disagrees, schedule a conversation to discuss the return-window provision; do not unilaterally extend the window.

Step 2 — Did the dispute cite a contractually-enumerated return reason?

YES (one of: duplicate, wrong number, out-of-geography, fails qualification, DNC match, consent defect) — proceed to Step 3.

NO (e.g., "the consumer never picked up," "the lead didn't convert," "the consumer wasn't interested when I called") — REJECT the dispute. Non-response and non-conversion are not qualification failures. Cite Exhibit C of the LPA and the principle that intake conversion is the buyer's responsibility. Offer to discuss the lead with the buyer to understand what they wanted that wasn't specified — this often surfaces a real gap in the qualification questions worth fixing in the LPA.

Step 3 — Did the buyer provide the required evidence?

YES (CRM record, attempt log, recording, screenshot — as required by Exhibit C for the cited reason) — proceed to Step 4.

NO — REQUEST the evidence in writing within [_____] business days. If the buyer cannot produce it, REJECT the dispute. Without evidence, the return reason is unverifiable.

Step 4 — Evaluate the evidence against your own records

Does the lead's TrustedForm certificate show valid consent capture? (If not, ACCEPT the return immediately and investigate the source.)

Does the lead's submission timestamp predate Buyer's evidence of submission (in a duplicate

dispute)?

Does the lead's submitted address match the geography spec in Exhibit A (in an out-of-geography dispute)?

Does the lead's qualification-answer record show "yes" to the qualifying question (in a qualification dispute)?

Was the phone number validated at capture (in a wrong-number dispute)?

Step 5 — Decision

EVIDENCE SUPPORTS THE BUYER → ACCEPT the return. Credit the buyer per the LPA. Investigate the root cause on the seller side (was a generator's filtering broken? a traffic source non-compliant? a phone-validation step misconfigured?).

EVIDENCE DISPUTES THE BUYER → REJECT the return. Provide the buyer with your evidence and explanation. Offer to discuss further.

EVIDENCE IS INCONCLUSIVE → SPLIT or escalate. Splitting credit (50% of refund) is sometimes the best path when both sides have plausible but unverifiable positions; escalating to a senior conversation on both sides is the alternative for higher-value disputes.

Step 6 — Track the dispute

Whatever the outcome, record:

Buyer-side signal: aggregate dispute rate

Track every buyer's overall dispute rate over a 30-day rolling window.

Industry-normal dispute rates by lead type (approximate, drawn from operator commentary): shared form leads, 5-15%; exclusive form leads, 8-20%; pay-per-call, 10-25%; CPA / signed-case, lower (typically 5-15%, since the buyer is not paying until conversion).

A buyer with sustained dispute rates 2-3x the norm is signaling something about their intake operation, not necessarily about your lead quality. Investigate before assuming the problem is on your side. Consider raising the issue directly with the buyer — sometimes the conversation surfaces a fixable intake issue (speed-to-call, agent training, qualification protocol) that improves the relationship.

A new vendor relationship typically runs higher dispute rates in the first 30-60 days as both sides

calibrate. Expected; do not over-react to early dispute-rate spikes if they normalize.

Standing disclosures

This decision tree is a research-based operational aid, not legal advice. Specific return-handling provisions should be negotiated into your LPA and reviewed by counsel. Industry-normal dispute rates are approximate ranges drawn from operator commentary and trade-publication content; your actual rates will vary by vertical, traffic source, and buyer profile.